A Few Beauty Spots

If you want to see leopards in Rajasthan, go to Jawai, where sightings are plentiful and the rooms cosy at Cheetahgarh

By Mitali Saran

The landscape is, of course, stunning—hills, thorn, sand, bursts of green, and a monsoon sunset pouring glory over all of it—but it's the rock that makes it so special. The desert scrub is littered with massive slabs of granite, vomited up by volcanoes and shaped by hundreds of millions of years of wind—scalloped, frozen into overhangs like cobra hoods, serrated into patterns, and nudged into arrangements full of cracks and caves that are just perfect for a leopard looking for shade and a little privacy.



ALL SET FOR A SAFARI
Rotela Lake at the foot of the Aravalis, a perfect starting point for some leopard-spotting in Jawai, Rajasthan